

Italics

ITALICS ARE LETTERS THAT ARE PRINTED AT AN ANGLE TO RESEMBLE HANDWRITING.

Words or phrases are styled in italic letters to distinguish them from the surrounding text. Italics may indicate a title, a foreign word or phrase, or emphasis.

SEE ALSO

◀ 108–109 Quotation marks

◀ 112–113 Exclamation points

◀ 114–115 Parentheses and dashes

◀ 120–121 Other punctuation

Capital letters 158–159 ▶

Abbreviations 172–173 ▶

Foreign words

Foreign words or phrases that have not been adopted into the English language should be written in italics. These are sometimes followed by a translation, either in parentheses or quotation marks. Genus and species names of living things are Latin words and should always be italicized. The genus starts with a capital letter, while the species is written in lowercase letters.

The foreign word is italicized. The translation is placed in parentheses.
oma (grandma)

The genus is capitalized. The species is written with lowercase letters.
Bombus terrestris (bumblebee)
The scientific name is italicized. The common name is placed in parentheses.

My *oma* (grandma) loves the I think *Big Beach Splash!*, a film

- If it is unclear whether a **foreign word** should be italicized or not, look it up in a **dictionary**. If the word is not in an English dictionary, it should be italicized.
- **Proper names** are **not italicized** even if they are in a different language—for example, *Londres* (French for London).

Punctuation

Do not italicize punctuation following words in italics unless it is part of the title or phrase being italicized.

The exclamation point is in italics because it is part of the movie title.

Big Beach Splash!,

The comma is not italicized because it is not part of the movie title.